



1 year jail, up to Dh1m fine for hiring help illegally

ABU DHABI
BY ALI AL HAMMADI
Staff Reporter

Private sector establishments and employers have been warned by the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratization (MoHRE) against hiring individuals without a valid work permit issued by the Ministry, even on a trial basis, whether in establishments or as domestic workers.

The Ministry emphasised that employing a worker in violation of labour laws for trial purposes to “regularise” their status is strictly prohibited.

Follow labour laws

The Ministry stated that any individual who obtains a work permit from MoHRE is covered by labour laws. Employers who hire workers without a valid permit are considered in violation of the UAE Labour Relations Law.

MoHRE stressed that hiring domestic workers without a licence is a serious offence, punishable by a minimum of one year in prison and fines ranging from Dh200,000 to Dh1 million, in accordance with Article 27 of the Federal Decree-Law on Domestic Workers.

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UAE trumps US, UK in happiness rankings

COUNTRY ONLY GULF NATION AMONG WORLD’S TOP-25

DUBAI
BY JAYDIP SENGUPTA
Pages Editor

The UAE trumped some of the biggest names in the annual UN-sponsored World Happiness Report, which was revealed yesterday on the International Day of Happiness.

With a ranking of 21, UAE is placed ahead of the United States, United Kingdom and Germany in the list of happiest countries.

The UAE is the only Gulf country listed in the top-25, with Kuwait ranked 30th and Saudi Arabia at 32nd spot. Oman is ranked 52nd and Bahrain 59th among other Gulf countries in the top-100.

Among South Asian countries, Pakistan is ranked at 109th, ahead of India at 118th. Afghanistan brings up the rear at 147th.

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The happiness rankings are based on a three-year average of individuals’ self-assessed evaluations of life satisfaction, as well as GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity and corruption.

Country rankings were determined on the basis of answers

people gave on being asked to rate their own lives.

The study was published by the Wellbeing Research Centre at the University of Oxford, and compiled in partnership with Gallup and the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network.

This year, the authors of the happiness report said new evidence indicates that engaging in acts of generosity and believing in the kindness of others are “significant predictors of happiness, even more so than earning a higher salary”.

Finland’s unbroken streak as the world’s happiest country continued for an eighth year, while the US fell to 24th place, its lowest-ever level in the global ranking. The UK was placed 23rd and Germany 22nd, just behind the UAE.



GULF NEWS RECEIVES RARE HONOUR

Gulf News Abu Dhabi Bureau Chief Abdulla Rasheed receives a certificate of appreciation for Gulf News’ coverage of the Gaza crisis, from a representative of the Joint Operations Command overseeing the ‘Gallant Knight’ operation, at the Armed Forces Officers Club in Abu Dhabi.

Ramadan Kareem

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PRAYER TIMINGS

IFTAR 18:34

Fajr	05:05	Shuruq	06:18
Dhuhr	12:29	Asr	15:53
Maghrib	18:34	Isha	19:48

IMSAK 04:55

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

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